

SOC002

How to write a strong thesis statement

- Your first step is to determine what kind of paper you are writing.
- Three kinds of papers: analytical, expository, and argumentative
- An analytical paper breaks down an issue or an idea into its component parts, evaluates the idea, and presents the breakdown and evaluation to the audience.
- An expository paper will explain something to the audience.
- An argumentative paper makes a claim about a topic and justifies this claim with specific evidence.

Guidelines:

- Your thesis statement should be specific and it should cover only what you will discuss in the paper and it should be supported with specific evidence.
- The thesis statement will appear at the end of the first paragraph of a paper.
- Your topic can change as you write, and therefore, you need to revise your thesis statement to reflect what is discussed in the paper.

Examples of thesis statements

- For an analytical paper, the thesis statement can be:
- An analysis of the college admission process reveals one challenge facing counselors: accepting students with high test scores or students with strong extracurricular backgrounds.
- Your paper should then discuss the following topics:
- Explain the analysis of the college admission process.
- Explain the challenge facing admissions counselors.

- For an expository paper, the thesis statement can be:
- The life of a typical college student is characterized by time spent studying, attending class, and socializing with peers.
- The paper should then explain how students spend their time studying, attending class, and socializing with peers.

- For an argumentative paper, the thesis statement can be:
- High school students should be allowed to take a year off to pursue community service projects before entering college in order to increase their maturity and global awareness.
- Now the paper should present an argument and give evidence to support the claim that students should pursue community projects before entering college.

Structure of an essay (Introduction, Body, Conclusion)

- Introduction paragraph:
- To craft a strong introduction begin with a hook
- A hook can be something compelling such as a question, a powerful quote, or an interesting fact.
- Then specify the background points that assist the reader in understanding the topic.
- Finally include a thesis statement.

Introduction

- A) Hook
- B) 2 Background points
- C) Thesis statement

Body

- A) Topic sentence with supporting fact 1 and supporting fact 2
- B) Transition sentence
- Your body paragraph needs to underscore the thesis statement, specify a topic sentence that conveys this and support it with 2 facts.
- End with a strong transition sentence that moves the reader to the conclusion.

Conclusion

- Re-statement of Thesis
- Summary of the main points
- Challenging the reader with some future scope

Citations

- Support statements and provide evidence via citations.
- One common citation format is the APA format:
- It follows the author-date method of in-text citation, which means that the author's last name and year of publication for the source should appear in the text, example: (Jones, 1998)
- One complete reference for each source should appear in the reference list at the end of the paper.
- Note: If you are referring an idea from another work but not exactly quoting the material, then make reference to the author and the year of publication and not the page number in your in-text reference.

- Jones (1998) found “some quote by jones here” (p. 105)
- (Jones, 1998, pp. 199–201)
- LastName, FirstName character., & LastName, FirstName character. (year). Paper title. Paper conference. DOI URL